

question word

A word is used to start **open questions**, e.g. **What, Which, Who, Why, How**.

question tag

A short phrase that makes a **statement** into a **question**, e.g. "isn't it" in **It's hot today, isn't it?**

reflexive pronoun

A word that refers to the **subject** of the **clause**, when the subject and **object** are the same, e.g. **myself**.

regular

A word that behaves in the same way as most words like it, e.g. **books** is a regular **plural noun** and **waited** is a regular **past simple** form.
see also **irregular**

relative clause

A clause that gives information about the **subject** or **object** of the **main clause**.

relative pronoun

A word that introduces a **relative clause**, e.g. **who**, **that**, **which**.

reported question

A question that is repeated after it was actually asked, often by another person, e.g. **She asked if the bus was full**.

reported speech

Statements and **questions** that are repeated after they were actually said, often by another person, e.g. **He said the bus was full**.

reporting verb

A verb that introduces **reported speech**, e.g. **say, tell**.

root

The part of a word to which a suffix or prefix is added, e.g. "employ" is the root of **employable**.

second conditional

A sentence with "if" that describes an imaginary future situation, or an impossible present situation, e.g. **If I were you, I'd take an umbrella**.

sentence

A group of one or more **clauses**.

separable phrasal verb

A **phrasal verb** that can be used with the **particle** after a noun or pronoun, e.g. **bring the subject up / bring it up**.
see also **inseparable phrasal verb**

short answer

An answer to a closed **question** that only uses the **subject** and **auxiliary verb**, e.g. **Yes, I do**.

short question

A question with just an **auxiliary verb** and **subject**, which is used to show interest in a conversation, e.g. **Is it?**

simple

Simple **tenses** are formed with a **main verb** only; they don't need an **auxiliary verb** in their **positive** forms.

singular

The form of a word that is used to refer to just one person or thing, e.g. **book**.
see also **plural**

stalling

Using words or short phrases in conversation to give yourself time to think about what to say, e.g. **Let's see...**

state verb (stative verb)

A type of verb that describes situations, thoughts, or feelings, e.g. **seem, think, like**.
see also **action verb**

statement

A **sentence** that offers information, i.e. not a **question** or an **imperative**.

stress

Saying one **syllable** in a word, or one word in a **sentence**, more strongly than the others.
see also **emphasis**

subject

The person / thing / place, etc. that usually comes before the **verb** in a **clause**.

subject pronoun

A word that replaces a **noun** as the subject of a **clause**, e.g. **I, she, they**.

subject question

A question where the question word is the **subject**, e.g. "Who" in **Who invited you?**
see also **object question**

subordinate clause

A **clause** which is dependent on the **main clause**, usually introduced by a **subordinating conjunction**.

subordinating conjunction

A word that links two **clauses** that are not of equal importance, i.e. a **subordinate clause** to a **main clause**, e.g. **because, if**.
see also **coordinating conjunction**

substitution

The use of a word to replace another, e.g. "He" in **He's in the kitchen**.

suffix

Letters at the end of a word that change its meaning, e.g. "-able" in **enjoyable**.
see also **prefix**

superlative adjective

An adjective that indicates the most extreme of a group of things, e.g. **best**.
see also **comparative adjective**

syllable

Every word is made up of a number of syllables, each of which contain a **vowel** sound, e.g. **teach** (one syllable), **teacher** (two syllables).

tense

The form of a **verb** that shows the time of the action, e.g. **present simple, past simple**.

third conditional

A sentence with "if" that describes an impossible past situation and its impossible result, e.g. **If I had studied harder, I would have passed the exam**.

time marker

A word or phrase that indicates a time, e.g. **now, at the moment, tomorrow**.

transitive verb

A verb that takes a **direct object**.
see also **intransitive verb**

uncountable

A **noun** that cannot be counted, e.g. **water, money**.
see also **countable**

verb

A word that refers to a situation or an action, e.g. **stay, write**.

vowel

The English letters **a, e, i, o, u**.
see also **consonant**

word class

Shows the function of a word in a sentence, e.g. **noun, verb, adjective** are all word classes.

word order

The position that different words have in a **clause**, e.g. the **subject** usually comes before the **verb**, and **adjectives of opinion** come before **adjectives of fact**.

zero article

When there is no article before **plural** or **uncountable nouns**.

zero conditional

A **sentence** with "if" or "when" that describes a present situation or a regular action, e.g. **If it rains, the roads flood**.